MILITARY SPECIFICATION
CARTRIDGE, 7.62X39MM, BLANK

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers Cartridge, 7.62X39MM, Blank for use in 7.62X39MM weapons for saluting and training.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-109	- Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-636	- Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Through Caliber .50
MIL-STD-644	- Visual Inspection Standards and Inspection Procedures for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-I-45607	- Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of

DRAWINGS

Munitions Command

C11738731	- Cartridge, 7.62X39MM, Blank
F11731590	- Packing and Marking, Cartridges, 7.62X39MM, Blank:Cartons; Box, Ammunition, M2A1; Box, Wirebound

FSC 1305

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2.1 (Cont'd)

PUBLICATIONS

Munitions Command
AMCR 715-505 - Ammunition Ballistic Acceptance Test Methods
Vol. 3 Test Procedures for 7.62mm Cartridges

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General.- The cartridge shall comply with the requirements specified on Drawing C11738731, referenced specification, and the following:

3.2 Primer sensitivity.- The energy imparted by a 3.94 ± .02 ounce steel ball falling 16 inches shall cause initiation of the primer. The energy imparted by a 3.94 ± .02 ounce steel ball falling 2.5 inches shall not cause initiation of the primer.

3.3 Residual stress.- The cartridge case shall not split when subjected to a one percent mercurous nitrate solution for 15 minutes.

3.4 Screen perforation.- The cartridge, when fired, shall not cause perforations of 0.1 inch or greater in diameter in a paper screen, placed in the line of fire at a distance of 15 feet from the muzzle of the weapon.

3.5 Fouling.- The fouling produced by the firing of 510 cartridges shall not cause a decrease in the cyclic rate by more than 15 percent from the first to the last burst.

3.6 Function and casulty.- The cartridge shall function without casulty.

3.7 Cyclic rate.- The cartridges shall operate the AK-47 rifle at a cyclic rate of not less than 475 cartridges per minute.

3.8 Noise level.- The noise level produced by the test cartridges shall be not less than 100 decibels when the noise level of 7.62X39mm ball production cartridges fired under identical conditions and using the same equipment except for the use of a blank firing attachment is 120 - 130 decibels.

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3.9 Workmanship.- The requirements for workmanship are as specified on the applicable drawings, referenced specification, and the following:

3.9.1 Metal defects.- The cartridge shall be free of folds, wrinkles, deep draw scratches, scaly metal, dents and other defects.

3.9.2 Foreign matter.- The cartridge shall be free of corrosion, stains, discolorations, dirt, oil, and smears of lacquer.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Quality assurance terms and definitions.- Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 for definition of quality assurance terms.

4.2 First article sample.

4.2.1 Initial production sample.- At the beginning of regular production, a sample shall be submitted in accordance with contract requirements and shall consist of 2500 blank cartridges and 500 primed cartridge cases. The sample shall be manufactured using the same materials, equipment, processes and procedures as will be used in regular production. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing, shall be the same as used for regular production and shall be obtained from the same source of supply.

4.2.1.1 Examination and test.- After inspection and provisional acceptance at source, the sample shall be inspected for all requirements of the drawings and specifications at a government laboratory or such other facility specified in the contract.

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4.2.1.2 Initial production sample failure.- Failure of the sample to comply with requirements of the drawings and specifications shall result in sample disapproval. Determination as to acceptability of any initial production sample shall be based upon results of initial tests only, and no second tests shall be permitted on that initial production sample.

4.3 Inspection provisions.

4.3.1 Lot.

4.3.1.1 Submission of product.- The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1.2 Lot identification.- Each lot of ammunition shall be identified as to type, caliber and model as well as with a lot number, as assigned by the procuring activity. Each lot shall be further identified by a Federal Stock Number assigned by the procuring activity.

4.3.2 Examination.- Examination for major and minor defects shall be performed on a class basis in accordance with the classification of defects, Table I, using applicable sampling plans and acceptance criteria of Standard MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) for the major class shall be 0.65 percent and the AQL for the minor class shall be 2.50 percent.

4.3.2.1 Classification of defects.- The classification of defects shall be as specified in Table I.

TABLE I

No.	Defect and Method of Inspection Visual 1/	Major	Minor
1	Discolored, dirty, oily, smeared		X
2	Corroded or stained, if etched		X
4	Round head	X	
5	Dent		X
6	Split 2/	X	
7	Perforation	X	
8	Draw scratch		X
10	Beveled underside of head	X	
12	Scaly metal		X
13	No chamfer on head (rim)		X
14	Fold		X

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4.3.2.1 Table I (Cont'd)

No.	Defect and Method of Inspection	Major	Minor
	Visual 1/		
18	Presence of head stamp	X	
19	Defective head		X
32	No primer	X	
33	Cocked primer	X	
34	Inverted primer	X	
35	Loose primer	X	
36	Nicked or dented primer		X
37	No waterproofing material (primer pocket joint)		X
38	Defective primer crimp		X
39	Missing or loose wad	X	
40	Opening between wad and case wall	X	
41	Wad and joint between neck and wad not completely covered by lacquer		X
	Gaging		
42	Total length		X
43	Cartridge profile failure (requiring more than 20 pounds dead weight to insert in profile and alignment gage)	X	
44	Diameter of extractor groove, max.	X	
45	Diameter of extractor groove, min.		X
46	Diameter of head, max.	X	
47	Diameter of head, min.		X
48	Thickness of head		X
49	Length to shoulder datum	X	
50	Depth of primer	X	
51	Diameter of mouth, min.	X	
52	Diameter of mouth, max.		X

1/ Refer to MIL-STD-636 for visual standards for defects 1 through 38, except defect No. 18. While no photographs of blank cartridges are included in this Standard, the cartridge case defects illustrated in the NATO 7.62mm section can be used. In the event of conflict between Table I of this specification and MIL-STD-636 as to defect classification, the classification specified in Table I shall apply.

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4.3.2.1 (Cont'd)

2/ A split shall be classed as a major defect regardless of location or occurrence of loss of propellant.

4.3.3 Tests.- The tests listed in Table II shall be conducted in accordance with the methods and procedures specified in 4.4.

4.3.3.1 Test samples.- The quantities for the various tests shall be as specified in Table II. Only cartridges having met the visual and dimensional requirements shall be used in the ballistic tests, and shall have been selected in such a manner that the sample is representative of the entire lot. The cartridges selected shall be thoroughly mixed before being divided into samples for the various tests.

TABLE II

Test	Number of Cartridges Ambient Temperature	Requirement Para.
Primer sensitivity 1/		3.2
Residual stress (mercurous nitrate 2/	50	3.3
Screen perforation 3/	210	3.4
Fouling 4/	510	3.5
Function and Casulty 5/	600	3.6
Cyclic rate 6/		3.7
Noise level 4/	30	3.8

1/ Prior to assembly into cartridges, a sample of primers from each primer lot shall be inserted into cartridge cases and tested for sensitivity. The cartridge cases for this test shall be taken from regular production. The test sample shall consist of the number of primed cartridge cases required for performance of a complete run-down test wherein fifty primers are tested at each height. If the average critical height ($\bar{H}$) plus five standard deviations (5 sigma) exceeds 16 inches, or if the average critical height ($\bar{H}$) minus two standard deviations (2 sigma) is less than 2.5 inches, the lot of primers shall be rejected subject to performance of a second complete run down test wherein one-hundred primers are tested at each height. Failure of the second sample to comply with the above criteria shall be cause for rejection of the lot of primers.

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4.3.3.1 (Cont'd)

2/ Failure of two or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If one cartridge fails in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. If any failing cartridges are found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

3/ Failure of eight or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If more than three, but less than eight cartridges fail in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. The lot shall be rejected if, in the combined first and second sample, eight or more cartridges fail to comply with the applicable requirement.

4/ This test shall be conducted on the initial production sample only.

5/ The lot shall be rejected when function and casulty defects plus all other firing defects exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample in Table III. If the number of defects found in the first test exceeds the acceptance number for the first sample but is equal to or less than the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, a second sample consisting of double the quantity specified under function and casulty test shall be fired in the service weapon specified therefor. This procedure shall apply regardless of the weapon or weapons in which the firing defects occurred in the first tests. If the total number of defects in the combined first and second sample exceeds the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected. If, in testing a second sample, defects other than those for which the second sample is being tested should occur to the extent that they exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected.

6/ The cyclic rate shall be determined during the firing of the function and casulty test. Failure of any burst to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot subject to the testing of a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample. Failure of any burst in the second sample to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.2 Firing defects.- Firing defects and acceptance numbers shall be as specified in Table III.

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4.3.3.2 (Cont'd)

TABLE III

Defects	Acceptance Numbers (First Sample)	Cumulative (First & Second Samples)
1. Primer		
a. Escape of gas through or around primer cup	12	32
b. Blown primer or primer falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt	0	1
2. Case		
Bulges, mouth or neck	12	32
Splits, neck, shoulder or mouth	12	32
Splits, body	4	10
Splits, through head	1	2
Complete rupture	0	1
Partial rupture	4	10
Detached metal 1/	0	1
3. Weapon stoppage 2/	12	32
4. Misfire	3	8

1/ Any particle of metal which becomes separated from the case between the mouth and the juncture of the shoulder and neck shall be classified as detached metal.

2/ All stoppages attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of misfire or complete rupture observed in all tests shall be included.

4.3.4 Packaging, packing and marking inspection.- During or immediately prior to the packaging operation, 100% examination of the cartridges shall be performed to ascertain that the cartridge type conforms to the drawing. Occurrence of another model blank cartridge or a dummy cartridge shall be classed as a major defect. Occurrence of any type other than those listed shall be classed as a critical defect. All nonconforming cartridges shall be rejected. Inspection for packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644 as applicable to the drawing.

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4.3.5 Inspection equipment.- Except as otherwise provided for by the contract, the contractor shall supply and maintain inspection equipment in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-I-45607.

4.4 Test methods and procedures.

4.4.1 Primer sensitivity.- The primers shall be inserted into the cartridge cases to the depth specified on Drawing C11738731. The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Volume 3.

4.4.2 Residual stress (mercurous nitrate).- Test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Volume 3.

4.4.3 Screen perforation.- The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Vol. 3.

4.4.4 Fouling.- The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Vol. 3.

4.4.5 Function and casulty.- The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Vol. 3. Two rifles shall be used and 300 cartridges shall be fired in each weapon.

4.4.6 Cyclic rate.- The cyclic rate shall be determined during the function and casulty test. The cyclic rate of each magazine fired full automatic in the rifle shall be recorded.

4.4.7 Noise level.- The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Vol. 3.

4.4.8 Defect penalty.- In any ballistic test, except function and casulty, in which the occurrence of a firing defect prevents the obtaining of a reliable result for the characteristic being tested, an additional shot shall be fired. That particular test shall not be penalized, but the acceptance or initial production sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with Table III.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing - Level A (Worldwide Shipment).- The cartridge shall be packed in accordance with Drawing F11731590 or as required by the contract.

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5.2 Marking and labeling.- Packing boxes shall be marked and labeled in accordance with the applicable drawings cited in 5.1.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.- Invitations for bids and contracts or orders will specify the following:

6.1.1 Title, number and date of this specification.

6.1.2 Type and level of packing.

6.1.3 Provision for the supply, maintenance and disposition of mandatory ballistic test equipment for acceptance inspection purposes.

6.1.4 Provision for the submission of acceptance inspection reports containing final inspection results for each lot of ammunition presented to the Government.

6.1.5 Requirement for contractor to provide and maintain an inspection system in accordance with MIL-I-45208, Inspection System Requirements.

6.2 Hazard notice.- The cartridge described herein and certain of its components are flammable and/or explosive and consequently present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage and shipment. The contractor should recognize these hazards and take appropriate measures to guard and protect against fire, explosion, adverse environment, corrosive atmosphere, rough handling and electrically induced incidents.

Custodian:

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Preparing activity:

Army - MU -(FA)

Project No. 1305-A663

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